

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 720

By Moon

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Eugene John Burke.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Eugene John Burke of Seymour; and

WHEREAS, Eugene Burke, born on April 6, 1936, in New York, New York, lived a life marked by kindness, dedication to family, and a willingness to serve others; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Burke worked as an educator in the automotive industry for over thirty years, sharing his knowledge and shaping countless careers; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Burke became a Freemason in the late 1980s while living in Grand Blanc, Michigan; he served as Master of the Charles Durant Lodge in 1997 and Master of the New Providence Lodge in Maryville in 2025; and

WHEREAS, he also was a presiding officer of the Maryville York Rite Bodies and achieved membership in the Knights of the York Cross of Honor Tennessee Priory; and

WHEREAS, Eugene Burke's favorite pastimes were spending time with his family and friends and working on home improvement projects; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to his family, Mr. Burke enjoyed the loving companionship of his wife, June, and was the proud father of two daughters, Dawn Burke Colvin and Deborah Burke; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his wife and children and a host of family and friends; and

WHEREAS, Eugene Burke was preceded in death by his brother, Raymond James Burke, Sr.; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Burke leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Eugene John Burke, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Burke.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.